Australian Metals & Mining

# Lithium: recutting our preferences. Where did all the free cash flow go?

**Rating Change**

## ASX lithiums: we still see an oversupplied market

Much has changed in two months. i) new supply has been sanctioned including ~150kt LCE from PLS/LTR ii) the gap between China ESS production and installations continues to weigh on sentiment iii) CATL's Jianxiawo mine has received environmental approvals (Bloomberg 30-Oct) iv) 2027 ESS order books expectations have edged lower and v) inventory levels have become more uncertain. Spodumene pricing has moved from US$2200/t to US$1300/t QTD with EPS momentum vs spot no longer favourable. A near-term catch-up in China ESS installations could support sentiment into year-end, but we expect an oversupplied market in 2027 even with no Jianxiawo. See Exhibit 9.

## Recutting preferences. IGO preferred in 'lower for longer'

With spodumene pricing having fallen below our US$1500/t expectations, we recut our pecking order. **IGO moves to Buy**, **PLS to Neutral and LTR remains at Underperform**. In a lower-price environment, we prefer IGO's exposure to the low-cost Greenbushes. See **cost curve** in Exhibit 5. We now see the balance of news as skewed to the upside for IGO with Greenbushes optimisation work substantially complete and TLEA dividends a potential DecQ catalyst. While we acknowledge that the timing and nature on Greenbushes disclosures remain opaque and Kwinana remains unresolved, we think these risks are increasingly reflected in valuation. **PLS moves to Neutral**: we like the A$2.2bn cash and operating track record but balance this against a period of expected negative free cash flow while funding P2000. See Exhibit 6. LTR remains at underperform; we model negative FCF until 1HFY29e into the 4Mtpa expansion.

## Trimming multiples. Valuation support but EPS headwinds.

We reduce multiples across our coverage to 1.0x P/NAV and 8x EV/EBITDA reflecting the sector de-rating. See Exhibit 16 and Exhibit 17. Lower prices are flowing through to FCF and EPS expectations. We now value all three on consistent multiples and look to FY28e EV/EBITDA for PLS and IGO given our weaker price expectations. On our estimates the peer group is pricing in ~US$1100/t (NAV=share price). Our LTR PO reduces 10cps to 80cps, PLS by A$1.50/sh to A$3.20/sh; and IGO by A$1.60/sh to A$7.30/sh.

## Lithium: can China ESS shipments outrun installations?

YTD China's ESS battery shipments exceeded our forecasts i.e. 700GWh 9M26 while installations have disappointed at 99GWh. The widening gap raises concerns around battery inventory and sustainability of production growth, particularly given geopolitical risks around ESS exports from China plus uncertainty around project economics. We thus see downside risks to 2027 China shipments. However, ex-China remains strong and data centres provide a new driver of ESS demand. See our China team's AI handbook.

**04 November 2026**

Equity
Australia
Metals & Mining

**Kate McCutcheon** >>
Research Analyst
Merrill Lynch (Australia)
+61 2 9226 5728
kate.mccutcheon@bofa.com

**Elaine Faddis** >>
Research Analyst
Merrill Lynch (Australia)
elaine.faddis@bofa.com

**Chen Jiang** >>
Research Analyst
Merrill Lynch (Australia)

**Paul Wiggers de Vries** >>
Research Analyst
Merrill Lynch (Australia)
paul.wiggersdevries@bofa.com

**Commodity Strategists**
**Michael Widmer**
Commodity Strategist
MLI (UK)
michael.widmer@bofa.com

**Exhibit 1: We move our Buy to IGO**
Summary of changes

| Stock | Old rating | New rating | Old PO | New PO |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| IGO | Neutral | Buy | 8.90 | 7.30 |
| LTR | Underperf. | Underperf. | 0.90 | 0.80 |
| PLS | Buy | Neutral | 4.70 | 3.20 |

**Source:** BofA Global Research estimates

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

>> Employed by a non-US affiliate of BofAS and is not registered/qualified as a research analyst under the FINRA rules.
Refer to "Other Important Disclosures" for information on certain BofA Securities entities that take responsibility for the information herein in particular jurisdictions.
**BofA Securities does and seeks to do business with issuers covered in its research reports. As a result, investors should be aware that the firm may have a conflict of interest that could affect the objectivity of this report. Investors should consider this report as only a single factor in making their investment decision.**
**Refer to important disclosures on page 13 to 17. Analyst Certification on page 12. Price Objective Basis/Risk on page 11.**


知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

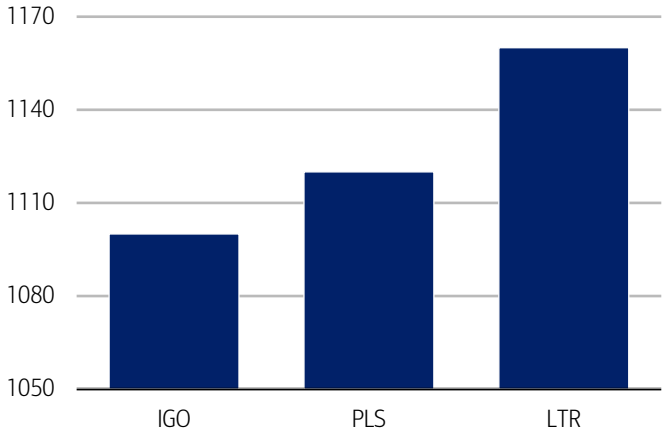
# Recutting our lithium preferences

## What's priced in?

When considering what's priced in, we look at what flat spodumene price is required for the share price to equal company NAV on a flat 0.7x FX. On our estimates the equities are pricing in ~US$1100/t which is below our long-term pricing expectations of US$1314/t (real, $2026). While we acknowledge the sector now screens attractive on valuation, we look for conviction in the 2027 ESS outlook; or supply discipline to turn more positive here. Supply disruptions from Zimbabwe for example could see upside to our pricing expectations.

See our Metals Strategists note encompassing lithium: Metals Strategist: Mined commodities resilient, but Iran war remains a headwind 30 September 2026

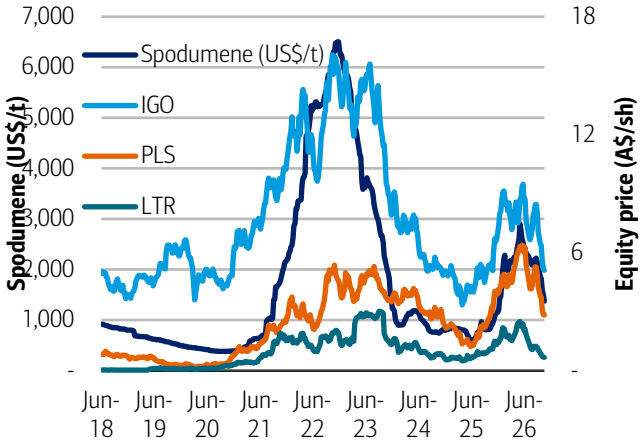
**Exhibit 2: What's priced in?**
Spodumene required for NAV = share price US$/t




**Source:** BofA Global Research estimates

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

**Exhibit 3: Equities are highly leveraged to lithium prices**
Spodumene pricing is now sub US$1300/t




**Source:** BofA Global Research, Platts, Fastmarkets, Asian Metals, Benchmark

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

## Changes to estimates: positioning to the defensive

With this note we make the following changes which are summarised in Exhibit 4.

- **IGO (Buy, PO A$7.30/sh):**
  - We update for the SepQ production result reducing our EBITDA by 6% in FY27e on Nova operating costs. SepQ saw a US$246m dividend from Windfield to TLEA. This implies TLEA has approx. A$500m in cash after losses at Kwinana at the end of SepQ given TLEA held cash of ~A$242m at the end of the FY. We expect cash to sweep from TLEA to IGO in DecQ which could provide a catalyst.
  - We trim our multiples to 1x P/NAV (from 1.2x) and 8x FY28e EV/EBITDA (from a blend of FY27/28e). Our PO moves to A$7.30/sh from A$8.90/sh.
  - We move from Neutral to Buy after the pullback. IGO has the highest TSR in our three pureplay ASX lithium equities.
  - A key risk to our relative preference for IGO is spodumene prices. In a volatile pricing environment PLS is often the "go to" lithium name given its market cap and liquidity. See Exhibit 21 and Exhibit 22.
- **LTR (Underperform, PO A$0.8/sh):**



知识星球：前沿信息收录
更多一手投研资料扫码加微信
知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

- We reduce our PO to 80cps from 90cps based on 1x P/NAV (from 1.2x) and 8x FY29e EV/EBITDA. We look to FY29e to account for 'steady state' earnings post the ramp up.
- On spot we estimate a cash-low of ~A$50m in FY28e vs our base case of A$150m (unchanged).
- We model LTR missing FY27 guidance after SepQ. See our SepQ Model update note.
- Related, see: Kathleen Valley: 4Mtpa gets the greenlight.
- We maintain our relative Underperform preferring established producers IGO and PLS.

- **PLS (neutral, PO A$3.20/sh):**
  - We reduce our PO to A$3.20/sh from A$4.70/sh based on 1x P/NAV (from 1.2x) and 8x FY28e EV/EBITDA (from 10x and a blend of FY27/28e).
  - On spot we estimate a cash-low of ~A$550m in FY29e vs our base case of A$1.1bn i.e. PLS has a defensive balance sheet. PLS ended SepQ with A$2.2bn in cash and net cash of ~A$1.3bn. Subsequent to the quarter end PLS issued a new US$700m bond. See: SepQ: More debt, more power, no plans to curtail.
  - Related: P2000: is bigger better? Maybe...but not without risks.
  - We move from Buy to Neutral recutting our preferences to favour free-cash flow generative names.

**Exhibit 4: Changes to estimates**
We now prefer IGO over PLS

| | | | | | | | 2027 EBITDA | | 2028 EBITDA | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Company | Rating | Old Rating | Price | PO | Old PO | % Chg | New | % chg. | New | % chg. |
| PLS | NEUTRAL | BUY | AUD 2.63 | 3.20 | 4.70 | -32% | 1,420 | -1% | 1,198 | 0% |
| IGO | BUY | NEUTRAL | AUD 4.98 | 7.30 | 8.90 | -18% | 457 | -6% | 364 | -3% |
| Liontown | UNDERPERFORM | UNDERPERFORM | AUD 0.615 | 0.80 | 0.90 | -11% | 256 | 0% | 246 | 0% |
| Average | | | | | | -11.8% | | -1.0% | | -0.2% |
| Median | | | | | | -11.1% | | 0.0% | | 0.0% |

**Source:** BofA Global Research estimates

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

**Table 1: Lithium has pulled back sharply**
In a "lower for longer" price environment we prefer IGO

| Lithium, USD basis | Last (USD terms) | 1wk Chg % | 1mth Chg % | 3mth Chg % | 6 mth Chg % | 1 yr Chg % | 2 yr Chg % | 3 yr Chg % |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Spodumene CIF US$/t | 1,425 | (8) | (31) | (35) | (42) | 50 | 90 | (29) |
| Carbonate US$/t ex-VAT | 12,441 | (6) | (24) | (33) | (47) | 16 | 27 | (42) |
| Hydroxide US$/t ex-VAT | 11,340 | (5) | (30) | (34) | (49) | 11 | 25 | (45) |
| Ganfeng | 5.33 | (3) | (18) | (29) | (59) | (44) | 11 | (10) |
| Pilbara Minerals | 1.84 | (9) | (29) | (36) | (59) | (10) | (3) | (25) |
| Albemarle | 90.56 | (8) | (13) | (24) | (53) | (6) | (8) | (29) |
| Mineral Resources | 31.3 | 1 | (12) | (23) | (35) | 1 | 17 | (21) |
| Liontown | 0.43 | (11) | (22) | (38) | (77) | (44) | (19) | (60) |
| IGO | 3 | (3) | (23) | (28) | (35) | (5) | (6) | (49) |

**Source:** BofA Global Research, Bloomberg
At close 3-Nov

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

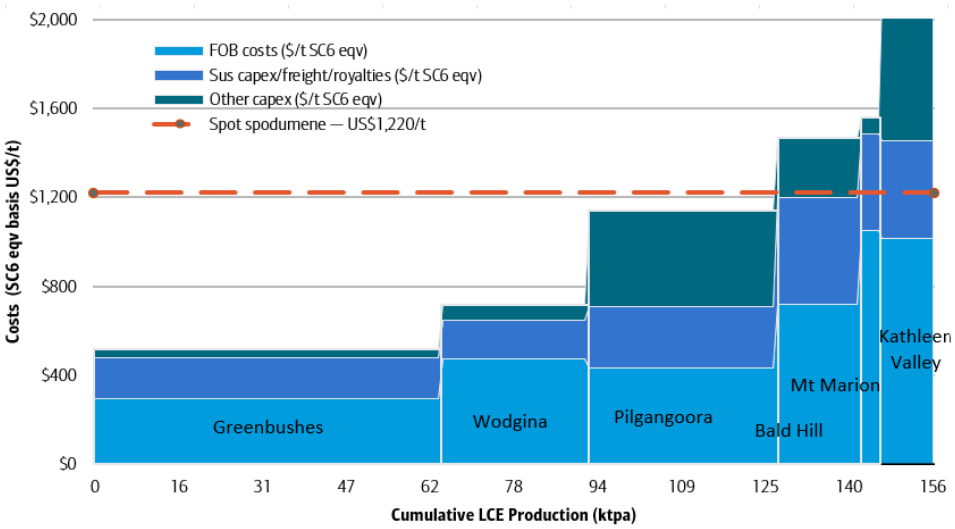


知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

知识星球：前沿信息收录
更多一手投研资料扫码加微信
知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

# Key charts

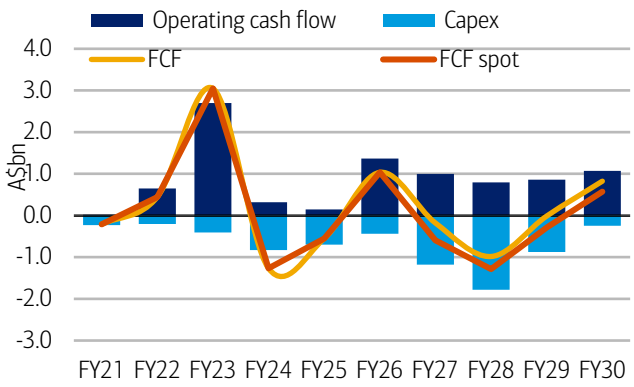
**Exhibit 5: SepQCY26 all-in cost curve for our ASX coverage**
On an annualised basis accounts for +30% of supply




**Source:** BofA Global Research estimates, Company Reports
Note where not reported costs are based on BofA's estimates of leases, capex, freight and royalties.

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

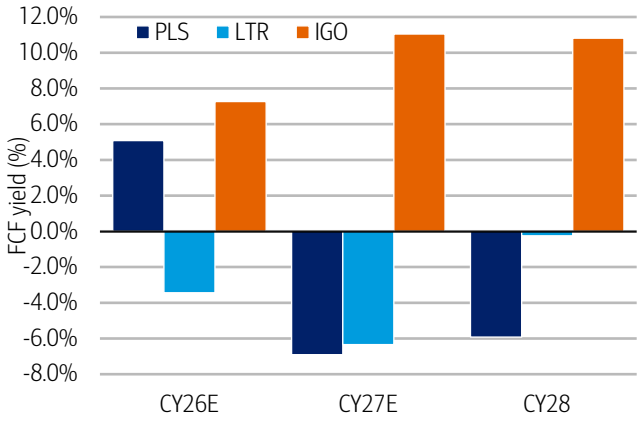
**Exhibit 6: Our expectations of FCF for PLS are dented by P2000**
PLS also added US$700m of bonds in Oct which adds interest expenses




**Source:** BofA Global Research, Bloomberg
Where spot is US$1180/t and 0.7 FX

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

**Exhibit 7: Our FCF expectations for our three pureplay ASX lithiums**
We model IGO generating cash through the cycle



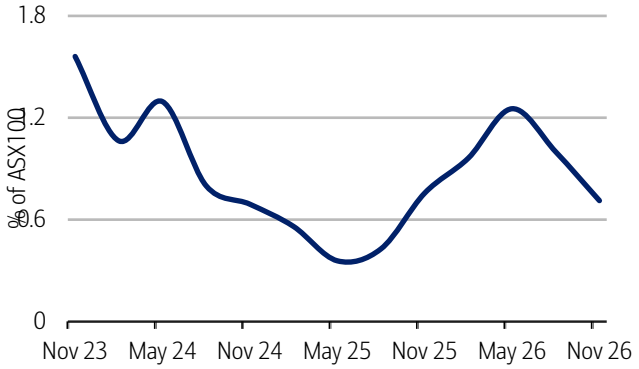

**Source:** BofA Global Research estimates

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH



知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

**Exhibit 8: Lithium as a % of the ASX100 is now <1%**
And we note weakened investor interest in the sector




**Source:** BofA Global Research, Bloomberg
Includes PLS, IGO, MIN, AKE, VUL, LTR, ELV

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

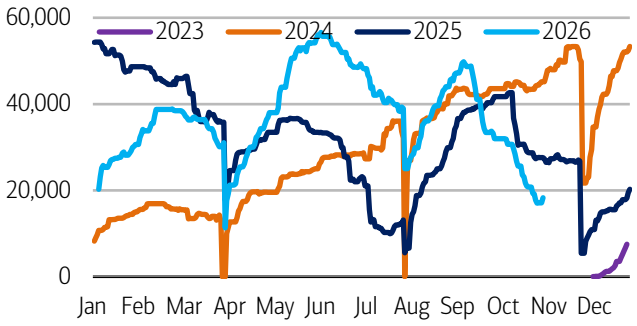
**Exhibit 9: Lithium to flip back into surplus in 2027**
BofA's Lithium supply and demand balance

| tonnes | 2023 | 2024 | 2025 | 2026E | 2027E |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Global production | 1,063,644 | 1,338,988 | 1,555,537 | 1,970,119 | 2,376,319 |
| YoY change | 43.4% | 25.9% | 16.2% | 26.7% | 20.6% |
| Global consumption | 987,178 | 1,223,590 | 1,578,812 | 2,051,709 | 2,350,650 |
| YoY change | 30.5% | 23.9% | 29.0% | 30.0% | 14.6% |
| **Balance** | **76,466** | **115,398** | **-23,275** | **-81,590** | **25,669** |
| **Spot ($/t)** | **40,469** | **12,420** | **9,563** | **19,198** | **15,500** |

**Source:** Company reports, CRU, IEA, BNEF, Bloomberg, BofA Global Research estimates

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

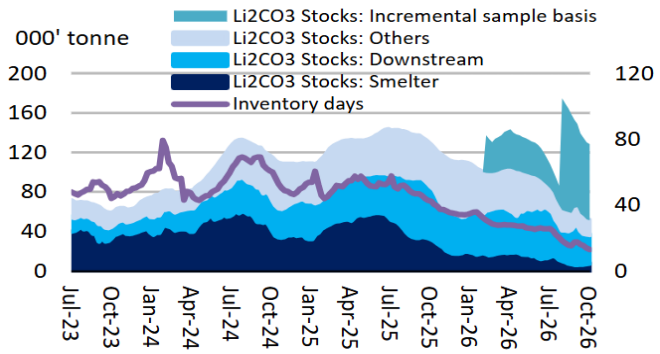
**Exhibit 10: GFEX lithium futures have been volatile**
Warehouse warrants at Guangzhou Futures Exchange (GFEX) (t)




**Source:** BofA Global Research estimates, GFEX, WIND

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

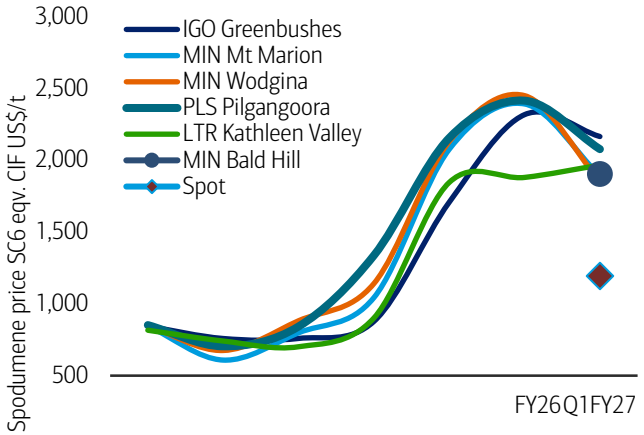
**Exhibit 11: Domestic lithium carbonate inventory**
China lithium carbonate inventory now 128kt at end Oct




**Source:** BofA Global Research, Bloomberg, SMM

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

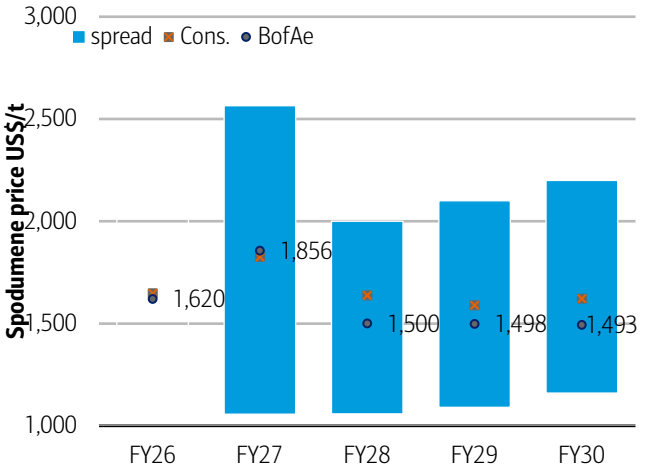
**Exhibit 12: Realised pricing on a SC6 basis**
For our ASX coverage universe by mine




**Source:** BofA Global Research, Bloomberg, Company Reports

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

**Exhibit 13: BofA is below consensus for spodumene price expectations**
Noting a large spread in expectations



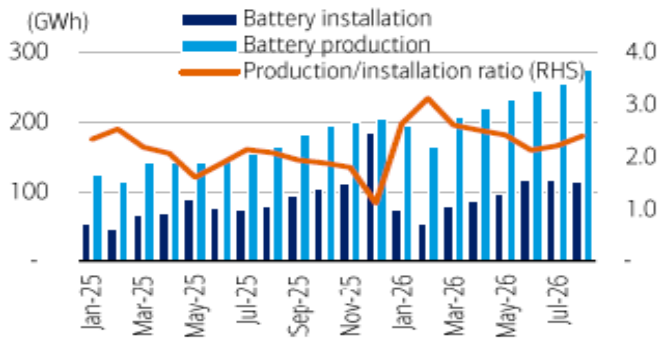

**Source:** BofA Global Research estimates, Visible Alpha
Note consensus taken from PLS

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH



知识星球：前沿信息收录
更多一手投研资料扫码加微信
知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

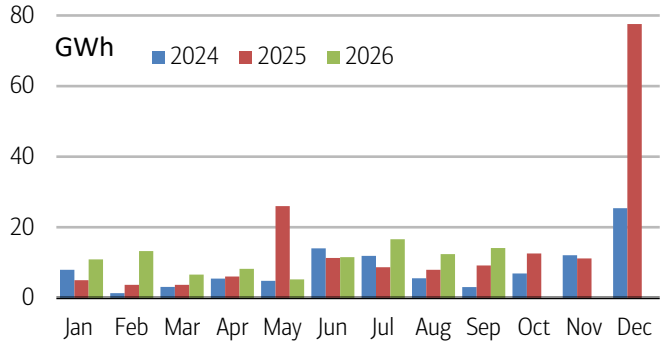
**Exhibit 14: Battery production vs installation**
Has been a key overhang on the market




**Source:** BofA Global Research, Bloomberg, SMM

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

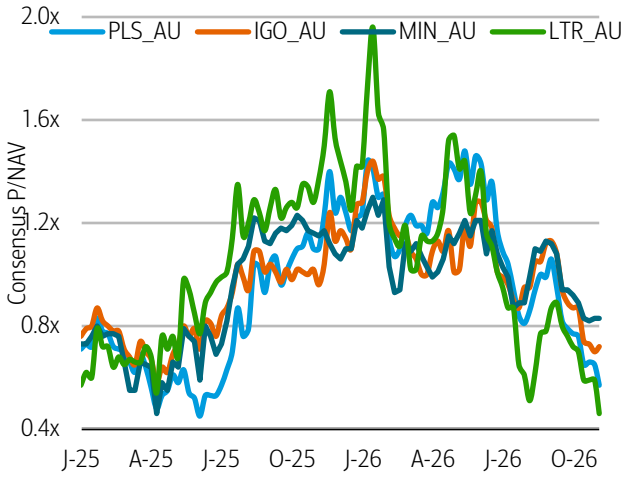
**Exhibit 15: China ESS installation**
Is typically seasonally strong in DecQ




**Source:** BofA Global Research estimates, SMM

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

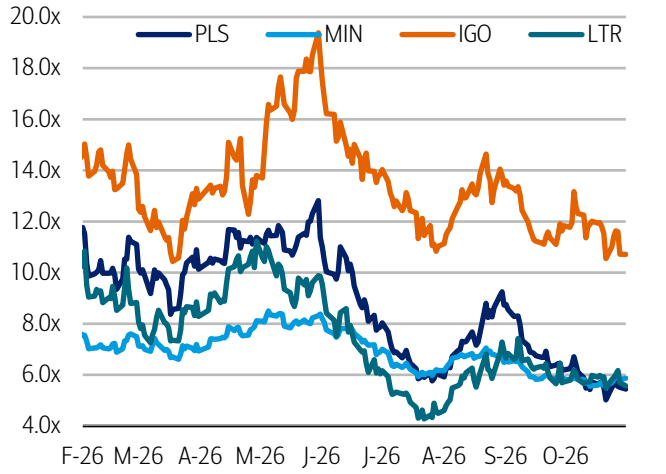
**Exhibit 16: Consensus P/NAV of lithium equities**
The group has de-rated




**Source:** BofA Global Research estimates, Visible Alpha

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

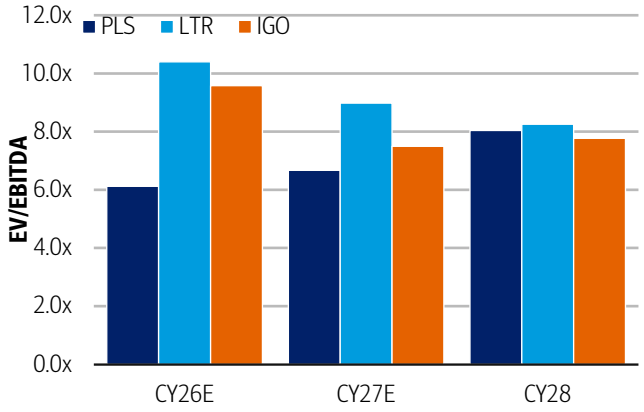
**Exhibit 17: EV/EBITDA one year forward**
Multiples have de-rated




**Source:** BofA Global Research, Bloomberg

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

**Exhibit 18: How we model EV/EBITDA for the equities**
LTR is ramping up Kathleen Valley




**Source:** BofA Global Research estimates, Visible Alpha

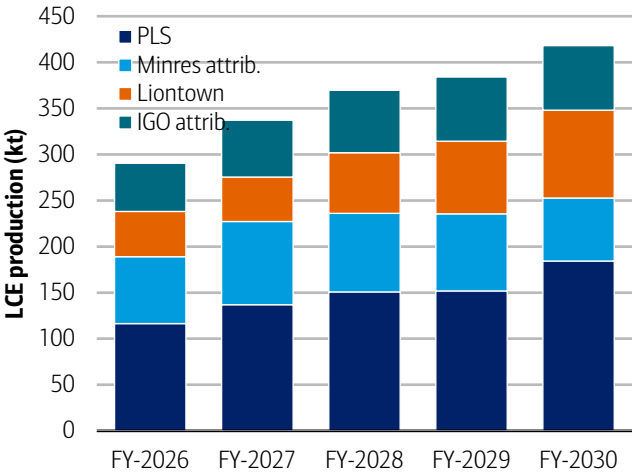
BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH



知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

# Companies in context

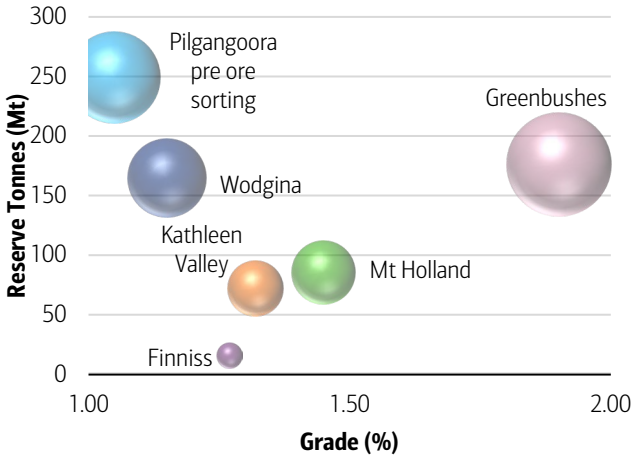
**Exhibit 19: PLS is the largest producer on the ASX in LCE terms**
Vs spodumene producers i.e. RIO not shown




**Source:** BofA Global Research estimates

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

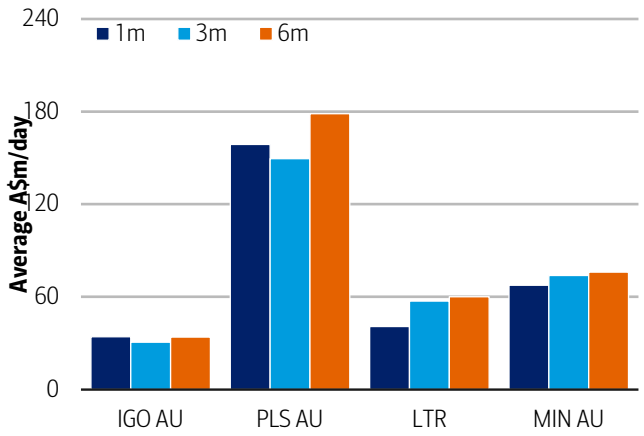
**Exhibit 20: Greenbushes is the highest-grade lithium mine in Australia**
Against other ASX spodumene reserves




**Source:** BofA Global Research estimates, Company Reports

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

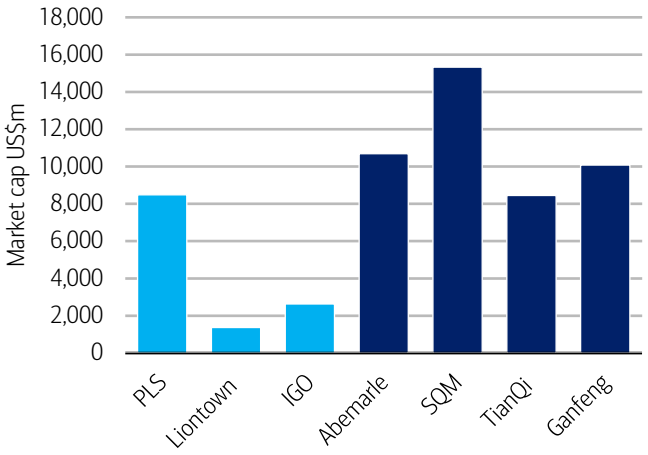
**Exhibit 21: PLS is the most liquid lithium exposed name on the ASX**
And also has the highest short interest




**Source:** BofA Global Research, Bloomberg

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

**Exhibit 22: Market cap of BofA's lithium coverage universe**
PLS is the largest ASX name




**Source:** BofA Global Research, Bloomberg

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH



知识星球：前沿信息收录
更多一手投研资料扫码加微信
知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

# Sensitivity

## IGO

**Exhibit 23: LTR sensitivity at various spodumene and FX prices**
Our LT price is US$1314/t (in $2026) and 0.72 FX

| NPV | Spodumene | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| FX | 1,000 | 1,150 | 1,300 | 1,450 | 1,600 | 1,750 |
| 0.60 | 5.5 | 6.9 | 8.2 | 9.6 | 10.9 | 12.3 |
| 0.65 | 4.8 | 6.1 | 7.3 | 8.5 | 9.8 | 11.0 |
| 0.70 | 4.2 | 5.4 | 6.5 | 7.7 | 8.8 | 10.0 |
| 0.75 | 3.7 | 4.8 | 5.8 | 6.9 | 8.0 | 9.1 |

| Valuation | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| FX | 1,000 | 1,150 | 1,300 | 1,450 | 1,600 | 1,750 |
| 0.60 | 5.8 | 7.0 | 8.3 | 9.6 | 10.9 | 12.2 |
| 0.65 | 5.1 | 6.3 | 7.5 | 8.7 | 9.8 | 11.0 |
| 0.70 | 4.5 | 5.6 | 6.7 | 7.8 | 8.9 | 10.0 |
| 0.75 | 4.0 | 5.0 | 6.0 | 7.1 | 8.1 | 9.1 |

| EBITDA underlying 27 | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| FX | 1,000 | 1,150 | 1,300 | 1,450 | 1,600 | 1,750 |
| 0.60 | 350 | 383 | 417 | 450 | 483 | 516 |
| 0.65 | 319 | 350 | 380 | 411 | 441 | 472 |
| 0.70 | 292 | 321 | 349 | 377 | 406 | 434 |
| 0.75 | 269 | 295 | 322 | 348 | 375 | 401 |

| FCF FY28 | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| FX | 1,000 | 1,150 | 1,300 | 1,450 | 1,600 | 1,750 |
| 0.60 | 209 | 281 | 352 | 424 | 496 | 568 |
| 0.65 | 163 | 229 | 296 | 362 | 428 | 494 |
| 0.70 | 124 | 185 | 247 | 309 | 370 | 432 |
| 0.75 | 90 | 147 | 205 | 262 | 320 | 377 |

**Source:** BofA Global Research estimates

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

## LTR

**Exhibit 24: LTR sensitivity at various spodumene and FX prices**
Our LT price is US$1314/t (in $2026) and 0.72 FX

| NAV A$/sh | Spodumene | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| FX | 1,000 | 1,150 | 1,300 | 1,450 | 1,600 | 1,750 |
| 0.60 | 0.69 | 1.13 | 1.58 | 2.02 | 2.46 | 2.90 |
| 0.65 | 0.40 | 0.84 | 1.25 | 1.66 | 2.06 | 2.47 |
| 0.70 | 0.15 | 0.58 | 0.97 | 1.35 | 1.73 | 2.11 |
| 0.75 | -0.08 | 0.33 | 0.73 | 1.08 | 1.44 | 1.79 |

| Valuation A$/sh | Spodumene | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| FX | 1,500 | 2,000 | 2,500 | 3,000 | 3,500 | 4,000 |
| 0.60 | 2.01 | 3.18 | 4.34 | 5.51 | 6.67 | 7.84 |
| 0.65 | 1.66 | 2.73 | 3.81 | 4.89 | 5.96 | 7.04 |
| 0.70 | 1.35 | 2.35 | 3.35 | 4.35 | 5.35 | 6.35 |
| 0.75 | 1.08 | 2.03 | 2.96 | 3.89 | 4.82 | 5.76 |

| EBITDA FY27e | Spodumene | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| FX | 1,500 | 2,000 | 2,500 | 3,000 | 3,500 | 4,000 |
| 0.60 | 352 | 497 | 642 | 788 | 933 | 1078 |
| 0.65 | 296 | 430 | 564 | 698 | 832 | 966 |
| 0.70 | 248 | 373 | 497 | 621 | 746 | 870 |
| 0.75 | 207 | 323 | 439 | 555 | 671 | 787 |

| FCF FY27e | Spodumene | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| FX | 1,500 | 2,000 | 2,500 | 3,000 | 3,500 | 4,000 |
| 0.60 | (54) | 91 | 219 | 321 | 422 | 524 |
| 0.65 | (110) | 24 | 158 | 258 | 352 | 446 |
| 0.70 | (158) | (33) | 91 | 204 | 292 | 379 |
| 0.75 | (200) | (83) | 33 | 149 | 239 | 321 |

**Source:** BofA Global Research estimates

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

## PLS



知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

**Exhibit 25: PLS sensitivity at various spodumene and FX prices**
Our LT price is US$1314/t (in $2026) and 0.72 FX

| NAV/share | Spodumene | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| FX | 1,000 | 1,150 | 1,300 | 1,450 | 1,600 | 1,750 |
| 0.60 | 2.87 | 3.80 | 4.73 | 5.66 | 6.60 | 7.53 |
| 0.65 | 2.39 | 3.25 | 4.11 | 4.97 | 5.83 | 6.69 |
| 0.70 | 1.98 | 2.78 | 3.58 | 4.38 | 5.18 | 5.98 |
| 0.75 | 1.62 | 2.37 | 3.11 | 3.86 | 4.61 | 5.35 |

| Valuation/share | Spodumene | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| FX | 1,000 | 1,150 | 1,300 | 1,450 | 1,600 | 1,750 |
| 0.60 | 2.22 | 3.02 | 3.83 | 4.63 | 5.43 | 6.23 |
| 0.65 | 1.81 | 2.55 | 3.29 | 4.03 | 4.77 | 5.51 |
| 0.70 | 1.46 | 2.15 | 2.83 | 3.52 | 4.21 | 4.89 |
| 0.75 | 1.15 | 1.79 | 2.44 | 3.08 | 3.72 | 4.36 |

| EBITDA FY27e | Spodumene | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| FX | 1,000 | 1,150 | 1,300 | 1,450 | 1,600 | 1,750 |
| 0.60 | 882 | 1054 | 1226 | 1398 | 1571 | 1743 |
| 0.65 | 793 | 952 | 1111 | 1270 | 1429 | 1588 |
| 0.70 | 718 | 865 | 1013 | 1160 | 1308 | 1456 |
| 0.75 | 652 | 790 | 928 | 1065 | 1203 | 1341 |

| FCF FY27e | Spodumene | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| FX | 1,000 | 1,150 | 1,300 | 1,450 | 1,600 | 1,750 |
| 0.60 | (565) | (463) | (362) | (260) | (158) | (56) |
| 0.65 | (616) | (522) | (428) | (334) | (240) | (146) |
| 0.70 | (660) | (572) | (485) | (398) | (311) | (223) |
| 0.75 | (698) | (616) | (535) | (453) | (372) | (290) |

**Source:** BofA Global Research estimates

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

### Abbreviations

ESS: Energy Storage Systems

GFEX: Guangzhou Futures Exchange

LCE: lithium carbonate equivalent

SC: spodumene concentrate

TLEA – Tianqi Lithium Energy Australia

**Stocks mentioned**

Prices and ratings for stocks mentioned in this report

| BofA Ticker | Bloomberg ticker | Company name | Price | Rating |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| IPGDF | IGO AU | IGO Limited | A$ 4.84 | C-1-7 |
| LINRF | LTR AU | Liontown Limited | A$ 0.6 | C-3-9 |
| PILBF | PLS AU | PLS Group Limited | A$ 2.6 | C-2-7 |

**Source:** BofA Global Research

## Investment Rationale

### IGO Limited

We rate IGO at Buy We like the 25% see through exposure to the first quartile [illegible]s mine and expected dividends. Against our lower for longer lithium price



知识星球：前沿信息收录
更多一手投研资料扫码加微信
知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

view, we expect Greenbushes to generate cash through cycle. While we lack visibility on a catalyst for IGO to exit the loss-making Kwinana which is consuming cash on balance we see risks as skewed to the upside.

**PLS Group Limited**
We rate Pilbara Minerals at Neutral. Positives include exposure to one of the largest and highest grade spodumene deposits globally, growth optionality via the brownfields P2000 or greenfields Colina coupled with a tenure of lithium production i.e. best in class operators. Downside risks include BofA's below-consensus lithium price expectations, risks that PLS fails to execute P2000 as expected and negative FCF over the P2000 build. On balance we see risks as evenly skewed.

## Price objective basis & risk

**IGO Limited (IPGDF)**
Our price objective of $7.30/share represents a 50/50 blend of a sum of the parts DCF valuation (1.0x NAV) and forward (FY28) see through Greenbushes EV/EBITDA multiple of 8x. We apply a wacc of 10% in line with our global base metals coverage. We use a LT (real) spodumene price of US$1314/t with an FX of 0.72x.

Upside risks: The share price could surprise to the upside if lithium prices are stronger than our estimates, leading to higher earnings and cash flow expectations. Resolving the Kwinana JV would also be a positive catalyst.

Downside risks: The share price could surprise to the downside if lithium prices are weaker than our estimates, leading to lower earnings and cash flow expectations. Similarly we consider operational risks inherent in mining as well as regulatory risks, counterparty (JV) risks. and an unfavourable acquisition

**Liontown Limited (LINRF)**
We set our 12m PO of A$0.80/sh based on a 50/50 blend of 1.0x NAV and 8x forward EV/EBITDA. A blend of NAV and EV/EBITDA is in line with our ASX mining coverage with multiples underpinned by comparable historical multiples. Our NAV uses a WACC of 10% in line with our coverage and LT (real) spodumene prices of US$1314/t SC6 with an FX of 0.72x.

Upside risks: The share price could surprise to the upside if lithium prices are stronger than our estimates, leading to higher earnings and cash flow expectations. Tailwinds also may include a faster or lower-cost than expected ramp up of the mine to the expanded 4Mtpa.

Downside risks: The share price could surprise to the downside if lithium prices are weaker than our estimates, leading to lower earnings and cash flow expectations. Similarly we consider operational risks inherent in mining such as ground conditions as well as regulatory risks.

**PLS Group Limited (PILBF)**
Our PO is set at A$3.20/sh based on based on a 50/50 blend of 1.0x NAV and 8 x forward EV/EBITDA (FY28). A blend of NAV and forward EV/EBITDA is in line with our ASX coverage universe with multiples underpinned by historical precedents. Our DCF assumes a discount rate of 10%. We price in a long-term spodumene price of US$1,314/t (real) and FX of 0.72x.

Upside risks to our PO are stronger-than-expected lithium prices and higher production of spodumene than expected. Better-than-expected execution on growth ambitions such as P2000 or Colina could also see upside to our estimates.



知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

Downside risks to our PO are weaker-than-expected lithium prices, failure to deliver on growth such as P2000 or an unfavourable acquisition. PLS is also exposed to risks inherent within mining such as weather events, geotechnical events or unplanned plant

## Analyst Certification

I, Kate McCutcheon, hereby certify that the views expressed in this research report accurately reflect my personal views about the subject securities and issuers. I also certify that no part of my compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or view expressed in this research report.

知识星球: 前沿信息收录
更多一手投研资料扫码加微信



知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

**Australia - Materials, Industrials & Energy Coverage Cluster**

| Investment rating | Company | BofA Ticker | Bloomberg symbol | Analyst |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **BUY** | | | | |
| | ALS Limited | CPBLF | ALQ AU | Cameron Needham |
| | Bellevue Gold | BELGF | BGL AU | Paul Wiggers de Vries |
| | BHP Group Limited | BHPLF | BHP AU | Kate McCutcheon |
| | BHP Group Limited | ZBHPF | BHP LN | Kate McCutcheon |
| | BHP Group-ADR | BHP | BHP US | Kate McCutcheon |
| | BlueScope | BLSFF | BSL AU | Chen Jiang |
| | Champion Iron | CIAFF | CIA AU | Chen Jiang |
| | Champion Iron | YCIA | CIA CN | Chen Jiang |
| | Evolution Mining | CAHPF | EVN AU | Kate McCutcheon |
| | Genesis Minerals | GSISF | GMD AU | Kate McCutcheon |
| | Greatland Resources | GGPSF | GGP AU | Kate McCutcheon |
| | Greatland Resources | XGRLF | GGP LN | Kate McCutcheon |
| | IGO Limited | IPGDF | IGO AU | Kate McCutcheon |
| | Iluka Resources Limited | ILKAF | ILU AU | Chen Jiang |
| | Lynas Rare Earths | LYSCF | LYC AU | Chen Jiang |
| | Mineral Resources | MALRF | MIN AU | Kate McCutcheon |
| | Minerals 260 | MTSZF | MI6 AU | Paul Wiggers de Vries |
| | NRW Holdings | NRWWF | NWH AU | Cameron Needham |
| | Ora Banda Mining | ESGFF | OBM AU | Paul Wiggers de Vries |
| | Origin Energy | OGFGF | ORG AU | Cameron Needham |
| | Sandfire Resources | SFRRF | SFR AU | Kate McCutcheon |
| | Sims Limited | SMUPF | SGM AU | Chen Jiang |
| | South32 Ltd | SHTLF | S32 AU | Kate McCutcheon |
| | South32 Ltd | XKTPF | S32 LN | Kate McCutcheon |
| | South32 Ltd | XMWTF | S32 SJ | Kate McCutcheon |
| | Ventia | XVXGF | VNT AU | Cameron Needham |
| | Westgold Resources | WGXRF | WGX AU | Paul Wiggers de Vries |
| | Whitehaven Coal Limited | WHITF | WHC AU | Chen Jiang |
| **NEUTRAL** | | | | |
| | AGL Energy | AGLNF | AGL AU | Cameron Needham |
| | Capricorn Metals | CRNLF | CMM AU | Paul Wiggers de Vries |
| | Deterra Royalties | DETRF | DRR AU | Chen Jiang |
| | Downer EDI Limited | DNERF | DOW AU | Cameron Needham |
| | Fortescue Ltd. | FSUMF | FMG AU | Kate McCutcheon |
| | Monadelphous | MDPHF | MND AU | Cameron Needham |
| | Northern Star Resources | NESRF | NST AU | Kate McCutcheon |
| | PLS Group Limited | PILBF | PLS AU | Kate McCutcheon |
| | Regis Resources | RGRNF | RRL AU | Paul Wiggers de Vries |
| | Rio Tinto Ltd | RTNTF | RIO AU | Kate McCutcheon |
| | Transurban Group | XTRAF | TCL AU | Lara Tufegdzic |
| | Transurban Group | TRAUF | TRAUF US | Lara Tufegdzic |
| **UNDERPERFORM** | | | | |
| | APA Group | APAJF | APA AU | Cameron Needham |
| | Coronado | CODQL | CRN AU | Chen Jiang |
| | Liontown Limited | LINRF | LTR AU | Kate McCutcheon |
| | Vulcan Steel Limited | XVULF | VSL AU | Chen Jiang |
| | Vulcan Steel Limited | XVSTF | VSL NZ | Chen Jiang |
| | Worley Limited | WYGPF | WOR AU | Cameron Needham |

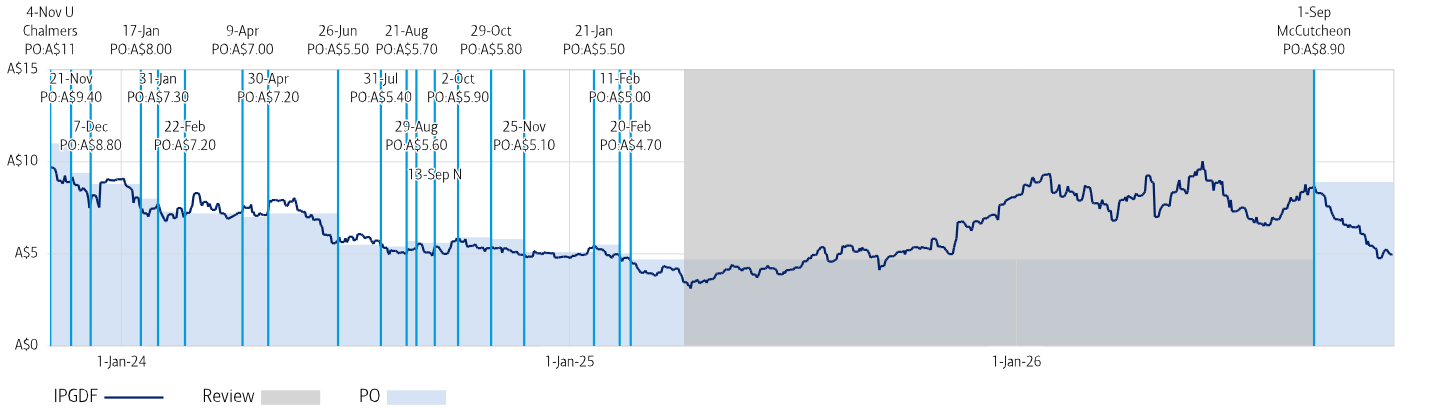
# Disclosures

## Important Disclosures



知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

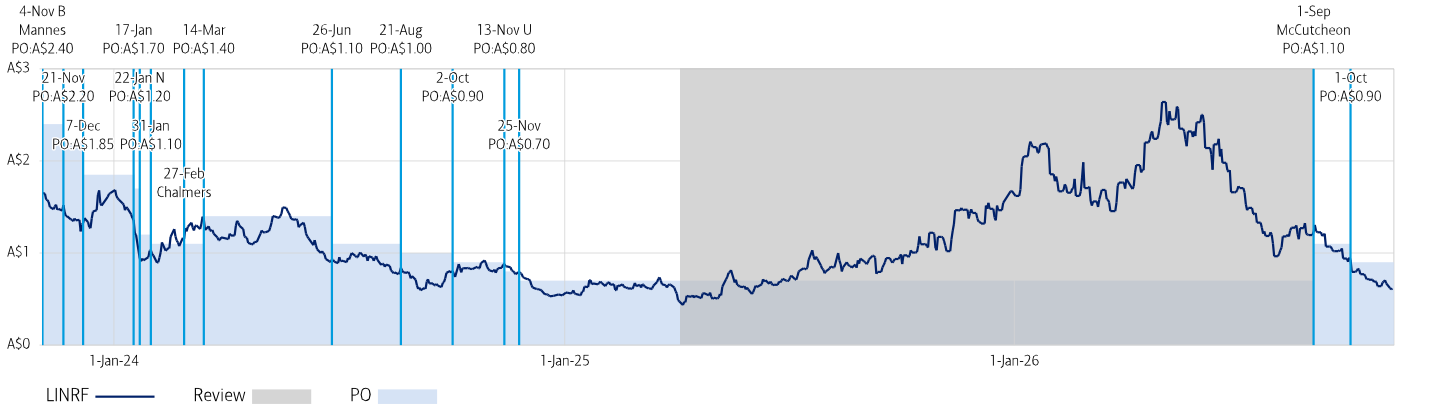
**IGO Limited (IPGDF) Price Chart**




B: Buy, N: Neutral, U: Underperform, PO: Price Objective, NA: No longer valid, NR: No Rating

The Investment Opinion System is contained at the end of the report under the heading "Fundamental Equity Opinion Key". Dark grey shading indicates the security is restricted with the opinion suspended. Medium grey shading indicates the security is under review with the opinion withdrawn. Light grey shading indicates the security is not covered. Chart is current as of a date no more than one trading day prior to the date of the report.

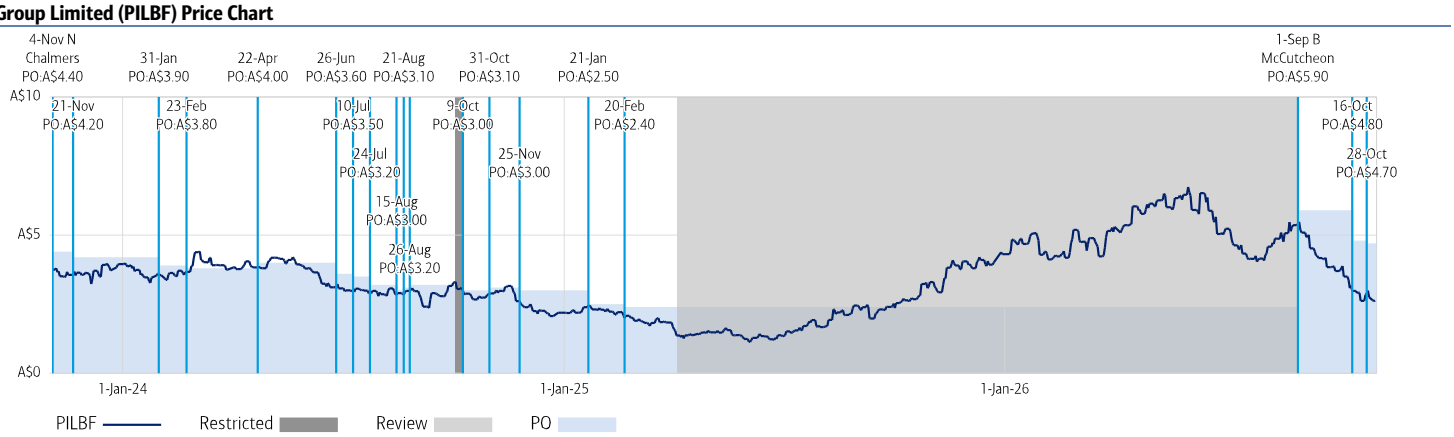
**Liontown Limited (LINRF) Price Chart**




B: Buy, N: Neutral, U: Underperform, PO: Price Objective, NA: No longer valid, NR: No Rating

The Investment Opinion System is contained at the end of the report under the heading "Fundamental Equity Opinion Key". Dark grey shading indicates the security is restricted with the opinion suspended. Medium grey shading indicates the security is under review with the opinion withdrawn. Light grey shading indicates the security is not covered. Chart is current as of a date no more than one trading day prior to the date of the report.

**PLS Group Limited (PILBF) Price Chart**




B: Buy, N: Neutral, U: Underperform, PO: Price Objective, NA: No longer valid, NR: No Rating

The Investment Opinion System is contained at the end of the report under the heading "Fundamental Equity Opinion Key". Dark grey shading indicates the security is restricted with the opinion suspended. Medium grey shading indicates the security is under review with the opinion withdrawn. Light grey shading indicates the security is not covered. Chart is current as of a date no more than one trading day prior to the date of the report.



知识星球：前沿信息收录
更多一手投研资料扫码加微信
知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

**Equity Investment Rating Distribution: Non-Ferrous Metals/Mining & Minerals Group (as of 30 Sep 2026)**

| Coverage Universe | Count | Percent | Inv. Banking Relationships [R1] | Count | Percent |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Buy | 75 | 66.37% | Buy | 50 | 66.67% |
| Hold | 22 | 19.47% | Hold | 16 | 72.73% |
| Sell | 16 | 14.16% | Sell | 9 | 56.25% |

**Equity Investment Rating Distribution: Global Group (as of 30 Sep 2026)**

| Coverage Universe | Count | Percent | Inv. Banking Relationships [R1] | Count | Percent |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Buy | 2057 | 57.03% | Buy | 1386 | 67.38% |
| Hold | 806 | 22.35% | Hold | 563 | 69.85% |
| Sell | 744 | 20.63% | Sell | 446 | 59.95% |

[R1] Issuers that were investment banking clients of BofA Securities or one of its affiliates within the past 12 months. For purposes of this Investment Rating Distribution, the coverage universe includes only stocks. A stock rated Neutral is included as a Hold, and a stock rated Underperform is included as a Sell.

FUNDAMENTAL EQUITY OPINION KEY: Opinions include a Volatility Risk Rating, an Investment Rating and an Income Rating. VOLATILITY RISK RATINGS, indicators of potential price fluctuation, are: A - Low, B - Medium and C - High. INVESTMENT RATINGS reflect the analyst's assessment of both a stock's absolute total return potential as well as its attractiveness for investment relative to other stocks within its Coverage Cluster (defined below). Our investment ratings are: 1 - Buy stocks are expected to have a total return of at least 10% and are the most attractive stocks in the coverage cluster; 2 - Neutral stocks are expected to remain flat or increase in value and are less attractive than Buy rated stocks and 3 - Underperform stocks are the least attractive stocks in a coverage cluster. An investment rating of 6 (No Rating) indicates that a stock is no longer trading on the basis of fundamentals. Analysts assign investment ratings considering, among other things, the 0-12 month total return expectation for a stock and the firm's guidelines for ratings dispersions (shown in the table below). The current price objective for a stock should be referenced to better understand the total return expectation at any given time. The price objective reflects the analyst's view of the potential price appreciation (depreciation).

| Investment rating | Total return expectation (within 12-month period of date of initial rating) | Ratings dispersion guidelines for coverage cluster[R2] |
|---|---|---|
| Buy | ≥ 10% | ≤ 70% |
| Neutral | ≥ 0% | ≤ 30% |
| Underperform | N/A | ≥ 20% |

[R2]Ratings dispersions may vary from time to time where BofA Global Research believes it better reflects the investment prospects of stocks in a Coverage Cluster.

*INCOME RATINGS*, indicators of potential cash dividends, are: 7 - same/higher (dividend considered to be secure), 8 - same/lower (dividend not considered to be secure) and 9 - pays no cash dividend. *Coverage Cluster* is comprised of stocks covered by a single analyst or two or more analysts sharing a common industry, sector, region or other classification(s). A stock's coverage cluster is included in the most recent BofA Global Research report referencing the stock.

Price Charts for the securities referenced in this research report are available on the Price Charts website, or call 1-800-MERRILL to have them mailed.
BofAS or an affiliate was a manager of a public offering of securities of this issuer within the last 12 months: PLS Group Limited.
The issuer is or was, within the last 12 months, an investment banking client of BofAS and/or one or more of its affiliates: IGO Limited, Liontown Limited, PLS Group Limited.
In the US, retail sales and/or distribution of this report may be made only in states where these securities are exempt from registration or have been qualified for sale: IGO Limited, Liontown Limited, PLS Group Limited.
BofAS or an affiliate expects to receive or intends to seek compensation for investment banking services from this issuer or an affiliate of the issuer within the next three months: IGO Limited, Liontown Limited, PLS Group Limited.
BofAS together with its affiliates beneficially owns one percent or more of the common stock of this issuer. If this report was issued on or after the 9th day of the month, it reflects the ownership position on the last day of the previous month. Reports issued before the 9th day of a month reflect the ownership position at the end of the second month preceding the date of the report: PLS Group Limited.
BofA Global Research personnel (including the analyst(s) responsible for this report) receive compensation based upon, among other factors, the overall profitability of Bank of America Corporation, including profits derived from investment banking. The analyst(s) responsible for this report may also receive compensation based upon, among other factors, the overall profitability of the Bank's sales and trading businesses relating to the class of securities or financial instruments for which such analyst is responsible.

## Other Important Disclosures

From time to time research analysts conduct site visits of covered issuers. BofA Global Research policies prohibit research analysts from accepting payment or reimbursement for travel expenses from the issuer for such visits.
Prices are indicative and for information purposes only. Except as otherwise stated in the report, for any recommendation in relation to an equity security, the price referenced is the publicly traded price of the security as of close of business on the day prior to the date of the report or, if the report is published during intraday trading, the price referenced is indicative of the traded price as of the date and time of the report and in relation to a debt security (including equity preferred and CDS), prices are indicative as of the date and time of the report and are from various sources including BofA Securities trading desks.
The date and time of completion of the production of any recommendation in this report shall be the date and time of dissemination of this report as recorded in the report timestamp.

Recipients who are not institutional investors or market professionals should seek the advice of their independent financial advisor before considering information in this report in connection with any investment decision, or for a necessary explanation of its contents.
Officers of BofAS or one or more of its affiliates (other than research analysts) may have a financial interest in securities of the issuer(s) or in related investments.
Refer to BofA Global Research policies relating to conflicts of interest.
**"BofA Securities" includes BofA Securities, Inc. ("BofAS") and its affiliates. Investors should contact their BofA Securities representative or Merrill Global Wealth Management financial advisor if they have questions concerning this report or concerning the appropriateness of any investment idea described herein for such investor. "BofA Securities" is a global brand for BofA Global Research.**
**Information relating to Non-US affiliates of BofA Securities and Distribution of Affiliate Research Reports:**
BofAS and/or Merrill Lynch, Pierce, Fenner & Smith Incorporated ("MLPF&S") may in the future distribute, information of the following non-US affiliates in the US (short name: legal name, regulator): Merrill Lynch (South Africa): Merrill Lynch South Africa (Pty) Ltd., regulated by the Financial Sector Conduct Authority; MLI (UK): Merrill Lynch International, regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA); BofASE (France): BofA Securities Europe SA is authorized by the Autorité de Contrôle Prudentiel et de Résolution (ACPR) and regulated by the ACPR and the Autorité des Marchés Financiers (AMF). BofA Securities Europe SA ("BofASE") with registered address at 51, rue La Boétie, 75008 Paris is registered under no 842 602 690 RCS Paris. In accordance with the provisions of French Code Monétaire et Financier (Monetary and Financial Code), BofASE is an établissement de crédit et d'investissement (credit and investment institution) that is authorised and supervised by the European Central Bank and the Autorité de Contrôle Prudentiel et de Résolution (ACPR) and regulated by the ACPR and the Autorité des Marchés Financiers. BofASE's share capital can be found at www.bofaml.com/_____; BofA Europe (Milan): Bank of America Europe Designated Activity Company, Milan



知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

Branch, regulated by the Bank of Italy, the European Central Bank (ECB) and the Central Bank of Ireland (CBI); BofA Europe (Frankfurt): Bank of America Europe Designated Activity Company, Frankfurt Branch regulated by BaFin, the ECB and the CBI; BofA Europe (Zurich): Bank of America Europe Designated Activity Company, Zurich Branch, regulated by the Swiss Financial Market Supervisory Authority FINMA, the ECB and CBI; BofA Europe (Madrid): Bank of America Europe Designated Activity Company, Sucursal en España, regulated by the Bank of Spain, the ECB and the CBI; Merrill Lynch (Australia): Merrill Lynch Equities (Australia) Limited, regulated by the Australian Securities and Investments Commission; Merrill Lynch (Hong Kong): Merrill Lynch (Asia Pacific) Limited, regulated by the Hong Kong Securities and Futures Commission (HKSFC); Merrill Lynch (Singapore): Merrill Lynch (Singapore) Pte Ltd, regulated by the Monetary Authority of Singapore (MAS); Merrill Lynch (Canada): Merrill Lynch Canada Inc, regulated by the Canadian Investment Regulatory Organization; Merrill Lynch (Mexico): Merrill Lynch Mexico, SA de CV, Casa de Bolsa, regulated by the Comisión Nacional Bancaria y de Valores; BofAS Japan: BofA Securities Japan Co., Ltd., regulated by the Financial Services Agency; Merrill Lynch (Seoul): Merrill Lynch International, LLC Seoul Branch, regulated by the Financial Supervisory Service; Merrill Lynch (Taiwan): Merrill Lynch Securities (Taiwan) Ltd., regulated by the Securities and Futures Bureau; BofAS India: BofA Securities India Limited, regulated by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI); Merrill Lynch (Israel): Merrill Lynch Israel Limited, regulated by Israel Securities Authority; Merrill Lynch (DIFC): Merrill Lynch International (DIFC Branch), regulated by the Dubai Financial Services Authority (DFSA); Merrill Lynch (Brazil): Merrill Lynch S.A. Corretora de Títulos e Valores Mobiliários, regulated by Comissão de Valores Mobiliários; Merrill Lynch KSA Company: Merrill Lynch Kingdom of Saudi Arabia Company, regulated by the Capital Market Authority.
This information: has been approved for publication and is distributed in the United Kingdom (UK) to professional clients and eligible counterparties (as each is defined in the rules of the FCA and the PRA) by MLI (UK), which is authorized by the PRA and regulated by the FCA and the PRA - details about the extent of our regulation by the FCA and PRA are available from us on request; has been approved for publication and is distributed in the European Economic Area (EEA) by BofASE (France), which is authorized by the ACPR and regulated by the ACPR and the AMF; has been considered and distributed in Japan by BofAS Japan, a registered securities dealer under the Financial Instruments and Exchange Act in Japan, or its permitted affiliates; is issued and distributed in Hong Kong by Merrill Lynch (Hong Kong) which is regulated by HKSFC; is issued and distributed in Taiwan by Merrill Lynch (Taiwan); is issued and distributed in India by BofAS India; and is issued and distributed in Singapore to institutional investors and/or accredited investors (each as defined under the Financial Advisers Regulations) by Merrill Lynch (Singapore) (Company Registration No 198602883D). Merrill Lynch (Singapore) is regulated by MAS. Merrill Lynch Equities (Australia) Limited (ABN 65 006 276 795), AFS License 235132 (MLEA) distributes this information in Australia only to 'Wholesale' clients as defined by s.761G of the Corporations Act 2001. With the exception of Bank of America N.A., Australia Branch, neither MLEA nor any of its affiliates involved in preparing this information is an Authorised Deposit-Taking Institution under the Banking Act 1959 nor regulated by the Australian Prudential Regulation Authority. No approval is required for publication or distribution of this information in Brazil and its local distribution is by Merrill Lynch (Brazil) in accordance with applicable regulations. Merrill Lynch (DIFC) is authorized and regulated by the DFSA. Information prepared and issued by Merrill Lynch (DIFC) is done so in accordance with the requirements of the DFSA conduct of business rules. BofA Europe (Frankfurt) distributes this information in Germany and is regulated by BaFin, the ECB and the CBI. BofA Securities entities, including BofA Europe and BofASE (France), may outsource/delegate the marketing and/or provision of certain research services or aspects of research services to other branches or members of the BofA Securities group. You may be contacted by a different BofA Securities entity acting for and on behalf of your service provider where permitted by applicable law. This does not change your service provider. Please refer to the Electronic Communications Disclaimers for further information.
This information has been prepared and issued by BofAS and/or one or more of its non-US affiliates. The author(s) of this information may not be licensed to carry on regulated activities in your jurisdiction and, if not licensed, do not hold themselves out as being able to do so. BofAS and/or MLPF&S is the distributor of this information in the US and accepts full responsibility for information distributed to BofAS and/or MLPF&S clients in the US by its non-US affiliates. Any US person receiving this information and wishing to effect any transaction in any security discussed herein should do so through BofAS and/or MLPF&S and not such foreign affiliates. Hong Kong recipients of this information should contact Merrill Lynch (Asia Pacific) Limited in respect of any matters relating to dealing in securities or provision of specific advice on securities or any other matters arising from, or in connection with, this information. Singapore recipients of this information should contact Merrill Lynch (Singapore) Pte Ltd in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this information. For clients that are not accredited investors, expert investors or institutional investors Merrill Lynch (Singapore) Pte Ltd accepts full responsibility for the contents of this information distributed to such clients in Singapore.

**General Investment Related Disclosures:**

Taiwan Readers: Neither the information nor any opinion expressed herein constitutes an offer or a solicitation of an offer to transact in any securities or other financial instrument. No part of this report may be used or reproduced or quoted in any manner whatsoever in Taiwan by the press or any other person without the express written consent of BofA Securities.
This document provides general information only, and has been prepared for, and is intended for general distribution to, BofA Securities clients. Neither the information nor any opinion expressed constitutes an offer or an invitation to make an offer, to buy or sell any securities or other financial instrument or any derivative related to such securities or instruments (e.g., options, futures, warrants, and contracts for differences). This document is not intended to provide personal investment advice and it does not take into account the specific investment objectives, financial situation and the particular needs of, and is not directed to, any specific person(s). This document and its content do not constitute, and should not be considered to constitute, investment advice for purposes of ERISA, the US tax code, the Investment Advisers Act or otherwise. Investors should seek financial advice regarding the appropriateness of investing in financial instruments and implementing investment strategies discussed or recommended in this document and should understand that statements regarding future prospects may not be realized. Any decision to purchase or subscribe for securities in any offering must be based solely on existing public information on such security or the information in the prospectus or other offering document issued in connection with such offering, and not on this document.
Securities and other financial instruments referred to herein, or recommended, offered or sold by BofA Securities, are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation and are not deposits or other obligations of any insured depository institution (including, Bank of America, N.A.). Investments in general and, derivatives, in particular, involve numerous risks, including, among others, market risk, counterparty default risk and liquidity risk. No security, financial instrument or derivative is suitable for all investors. Digital assets are extremely speculative, volatile and are not regulated in a manner similar to U.S. securities markets. In some cases, securities and other financial instruments may be difficult to value or sell and reliable information about the value or risks related to the security or financial instrument may be difficult to obtain. Investors should note that income from such securities and other financial instruments, if any, may fluctuate and that price or value of such securities and instruments may rise or fall and, in some cases, investors may lose their entire principal investment. Past performance is not necessarily a guide to future performance. Levels and basis for taxation may change.
This report may contain a short-term trading idea or recommendation, which highlights a specific near-term catalyst or event impacting the issuer or the market that is anticipated to have a short-term price impact on the equity securities of the issuer. Short-term trading ideas and recommendations are different from and do not affect a stock's fundamental equity rating, which reflects both a longer term total return expectation and attractiveness for investment relative to other stocks within its Coverage Cluster. Short-term trading ideas and recommendations may be more or less positive than a stock's fundamental equity rating.
BofA Securities is aware that the implementation of the ideas expressed in this report may depend upon an investor's ability to "short" securities or other financial instruments and that such action may be limited by regulations prohibiting or restricting "shortselling" in many jurisdictions. Investors are urged to seek advice regarding the applicability of such regulations prior to executing any short idea contained in this report.
Foreign currency rates of exchange may adversely affect the value, price or income of any security or financial instrument mentioned herein. Investors in such securities and instruments, including ADRs, effectively assume currency risk.
BofAS or one of its affiliates is a regular issuer of traded financial instruments linked to securities or digital assets that may have been recommended or discussed in this report. BofAS or one of its affiliates may, at any time, hold a trading position (long or short) in the securities and financial instruments recommended or discussed in this report.
BofA Securities, through business units other than BofA Global Research, may have issued and may in the future issue trading ideas or recommendations that are inconsistent with, and reach different conclusions from, the information presented herein. Such ideas or recommendations may reflect different time frames, assumptions, views and analytical methods of the persons who prepared them, and BofA Securities is under no obligation to ensure that such other trading ideas or recommendations are brought to the attention of any recipient of this information.
In the event that the recipient received this information pursuant to a contract between the recipient and BofAS for the provision of research services for a separate fee, and in connection therewith BofAS may be deemed to be acting as an investment adviser, such status relates, if at all, solely to the person with whom BofAS has contracted directly and does not extend beyond the delivery of this report (unless otherwise agreed specifically in writing by BofAS). If such recipient uses the services of BofAS in connection with the sale or purchase of a security referred to herein, BofAS may act as principal for its own account or as agent for another person. BofAS is and continues to act solely as a broker-dealer in connection with the execution of any transactions, including transactions in any securities referred to herein.

**Copyright and General Information:**

Copyright 2026 Bank of America Corporation. All rights reserved. iQdatabase® is a registered service mark of Bank of America Corporation. This information is prepared for the use of BofA Securities clients and may not be redistributed, retransmitted or disclosed, in whole or in part, or in any form or manner, without the express written consent of BofA Securities. This document and its content is provided solely for informational purposes and cannot be used for training or developing artificial intelligence (AI) models or as an input in any AI application (collectively, an AI tool). Any attempt to utilize this document or any of its content in connection with an AI tool without explicit written permission from BofA Global Research is strictly prohibited. BofA Global Research leverages AI, including machine learning and other technologies, to enhance the services we provide to our clients. These technologies assist our analysts in various aspects of their work,



知识星球：前沿信息收录
更多一手投研资料扫码加微信
知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

including but not limited to data analysis, content extraction, content creation, data aggregation and summarization and identifying relevant information from diverse sources. All AI-driven processes are subject to review by BofA Global Research employees. BofA Global Research information is distributed simultaneously to internal and client websites and other portals by BofA Securities and is not publicly-available material. Any unauthorized use or disclosure is prohibited. Receipt and review of this information constitutes your agreement not to redistribute, retransmit, or disclose to others the contents, opinions, conclusion, or information contained herein (including any investment recommendations, estimates or price targets) without first obtaining express permission from an authorized officer of BofA Securities.

Materials prepared by BofA Global Research personnel are based on public information. Facts and views presented in this material have not been reviewed by, and may not reflect information known to, professionals in other business areas of BofA Securities, including investment banking personnel. BofA Securities has established information barriers between BofA Global Research and certain business groups. As a result, BofA Securities does not disclose certain client relationships with, or compensation received from, such issuers. To the extent this material discusses any legal proceeding or issues, it has not been prepared as nor is it intended to express any legal conclusion, opinion or advice. Investors should consult their own legal advisers as to issues of law relating to the subject matter of this material. BofA Global Research personnel's knowledge of legal proceedings in which any BofA Securities entity and/or its directors, officers and employees may be plaintiffs, defendants, co-defendants or co-plaintiffs with or involving issuers mentioned in this material is based on public information. Facts and views presented in this material that relate to any such proceedings have not been reviewed by, discussed with, and may not reflect information known to, professionals in other business areas of BofA Securities in connection with the legal proceedings or matters relevant to such proceedings.

This information has been prepared independently of any issuer of securities mentioned herein and not in connection with any proposed offering of securities or as agent of any issuer of any securities. None of BofAS any of its affiliates or their research analysts has any authority whatsoever to make any representation or warranty on behalf of the issuer(s). BofA Global Research policy prohibits research personnel from disclosing a recommendation, investment rating, or investment thesis for review by an issuer prior to the publication of a research report containing such rating, recommendation or investment thesis.

Any information relating to sustainability in this material is limited as discussed herein and is not intended to provide a comprehensive view on any sustainability claim with respect to any issuer or security.

Any information relating to the tax status of financial instruments discussed herein is not intended to provide tax advice or to be used by anyone to provide tax advice. Investors are urged to seek tax advice based on their particular circumstances from an independent tax professional.

The information herein (other than disclosure information relating to BofA Securities and its affiliates) was obtained from various sources and we do not guarantee its accuracy. This information may contain links to third-party websites. BofA Securities is not responsible for the content of any third-party website or any linked content contained in a third-party website. Content contained on such third-party websites is not part of this information and is not incorporated by reference. The inclusion of a link does not imply any endorsement by or any affiliation with BofA Securities. Access to any third-party website is at your own risk, and you should always review the terms and privacy policies at third-party websites before submitting any personal information to them. BofA Securities is not responsible for such terms and privacy policies and expressly disclaims any liability for them.

All opinions, projections and estimates constitute the judgment of the author as of the date of publication and are subject to change without notice. Prices also are subject to change without notice. BofA Securities is under no obligation to update this information and BofA Securities ability to publish information on the subject issuer(s) in the future is subject to applicable quiet periods. You should therefore assume that BofA Securities will not update any fact, circumstance or opinion contained herein.

Subject to the quiet period applicable under laws of the various jurisdictions in which we distribute research reports and other legal and BofA Securities policy-related restrictions on the publication of research reports, fundamental equity reports are produced on a regular basis as necessary to keep the investment recommendation current.

Certain outstanding reports or investment opinions relating to securities, financial instruments and/or issuers may no longer be current. Always refer to the most recent research report relating to an issuer prior to making an investment decision.

In some cases, an issuer may be classified as Restricted or may be Under Review or Extended Review. In each case, investors should consider any investment opinion relating to such issuer (or its security and/or financial instruments) to be suspended or withdrawn and should not rely on the analyses and investment opinion(s) pertaining to such issuer (or its securities and/or financial instruments) nor should the analyses or opinion(s) be considered a solicitation of any kind. Sales persons and financial advisors affiliated with BofAS or any of its affiliates may not solicit purchases of securities or financial instruments that are Restricted or Under Review and may only solicit securities under Extended Review in accordance with firm policies.

Neither BofA Securities nor any officer or employee of BofA Securities accepts any liability whatsoever for any direct, indirect or consequential damages or losses arising from any use of this information.



知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88